

Python Programming Language History

Python was created by Guido van Rossum at the Centrum Wiskunde & Informatica (CWI) in Amsterdam. Work began in December 1989 as a successor to the ABC language. The first public release, version 0.9.0, was published in February 1991 on the alt.sources newsgroup.

Python 2.0 was released in October 2000, introducing list comprehensions and a garbage collector for reference cycles. Python 3.0, released in December 2008, was a backwards-incompatible redesign that unified text and bytes.

Guido van Rossum stepped down as Benevolent Dictator for Life in July 2018. Leadership passed to a five-person Steering Council elected annually by the Python Software Foundation.

The language is widely used in data science (NumPy by Travis Oliphant, pandas by Wes McKinney, scikit-learn), machine learning (PyTorch by Meta, TensorFlow by Google), and web development (Django, Flask).